



Figure 1: Similar pages



Figure 2: Complex request

Playing with photos

Photos are the most searched for and most interesting facet of Facebook search. Accessing all the photos of a friend or of people you like is great fun. Facebook exposes a set of RESTful APIs to get the photos you want:

- (a) photos
- (b) photos-by
- (c) photos-of
- (d) photos-uploaded
- (e) photos-tagged

As an example, www.facebook.com/search/58079349432/photos will work on the id of profiles, pages, etc, and shows either the photos accessible to you or just the publicly accessible photos. However, there is no magic in this, as it is equivalent to doing a search with Facebook's search bar with the string 'Photos of Open Source For You'.

Let us suppose you want all the pages that have names similar to 'open source'; these queries become essential for enthusiastic people who want to discover everything. Facebook allows you to do that. To search in this manner, use www.facebook.com/search/str/open_source/pages-named

The supported RESTful APIs for the string search are:

- (a) pages-named
- (b) users-named
- (c) places-named
- (d) apps-named

Note: Remember, Facebook's search allows access to only those objects which are either shared with you or have been publicly uploaded. By using either the search bar or RESTful APIs you won't be able to fetch the objects for which you've not been given access rights.

Pages – an easy way to build awareness

Pages are an integral part of Facebook's search graphs; hence many options are specially made available for pages, their suggestions and recommendations. Some of the APIs that allow you to play with pages are as follows:

- (a) `user_id/pages-recommended-for`
- (b) `page_id/pages-similar-to`

An example is www.facebook.com/search/58079349432/pages-similar-to

Apps – we need them, don't we?

Getting those annoying requests of *Ville? Well, do not worry if the REST APIs are there. Get app recommendations directly from Facebook, using the following patterns:

- (a) `user_id/apps-used`
- (b) `user_id/apps-liked`
- (c) `user_id/apps-recommended-for`

An example is www.facebook.com/search/me/apps-recommended-for

What's new here?

All the above searches that we explored can be easily done with the search bar provided right on top of Facebook's page. But, there's a key element that you often miss while querying on the search bar: That's the art of combining queries: *intersect*.

intersect is the element that allows you to combine searches. For example, if we want to query who are the Facebook users who are residents of Bengaluru and like the page OpenSourceForU, this query would be converted into a REST API as follows:

www.facebook.com/search/106377336067638/residents/present/58079349432/likers/intersect

Prefix: 106377336067638
Query1: residents/present/
58079349432/likers/intersect
Query2: 58079349432/likers/intersect
ANDing

This is a basic illustration of how *intersect* is used. But